



Sailing Instructions for Royal Cork Yacht Club Autumn League 2026

Racing Rules

1. All races in the series shall be governed by the Racing Rules of Sailing (RRS), Irish Sailing (IS) Prescriptions, the Notice of Race (NOR), the Sailing Instructions (SIs) and any amendments thereto.
2. Competitors in IRC (International Rating Certificate) and ECHO classes shall, in addition comply with the rules of these systems.
3. IRC Rule 22.4.2 (Crew number/weight) shall not apply. There will be no limitations on crew number or weight.

Entry and Eligibility

4. The series is an open event.
5. All those racing in the series shall submit a completed entry form online as per the following link [Royal Cork Yacht Club Autumn League Entry Form 2026 - Royal Cork Yacht Club](#)
6. An entry fee of €120 per boat shall also be submitted as part of the entry form.
7. A valid IRC certificate is required to have a valid entry for IRC results.
8. A valid ECHO certificate is required to have a valid entry for ECHO results.

Notices to Competitors

9. Notices to competitors will be posted on the Official Club Notice Board which is located on the RCYC website <https://www.royalcork.com/notice-board/>

Changes to Sailing Instructions

10. Any change(s) to the SIs will be posted on the Official Notice Board not later than two hours before the scheduled start of the first race of the day.

Signals made Ashore

11. Signals made ashore will be displayed on the Club flag staff.
12. When flag AP is displayed ashore, '1 minute' is replaced with 'not less than 60 minutes' in the race signal AP.

Sail numbers & Classes

13. Boats shall show their correct sail number. Permission to race using any other sail number must be sought from the Race Committee prior to going afloat. Any boat not showing its correct sail number may not be scored.
14. The Race Committee reserves the right to place any boat in any class it deems appropriate.
15. The ICRA class which is open to boats which satisfy the definition of "Cruiser" as set out in the ICRA constitution.

16. Boats shall display the class flag corresponding to their entered class while racing. Class flags shall be flown from the yacht's backstay or, where this is not practicable, from a prominent position clearly visible from astern. The class flags to be used are listed in the table below

Class	Flag
Class 1 + ICRA Class 1	Numeral Pennant 1
Class 2 + ICRA Class 2	Numeral Pennant 2
Class 3 + ICRA Class 3	Numeral Pennant 3
Non-Spin Class 1	W/Sail Class Flag
Non-Spin Class 2	W/Sail Class Flag

Local Harbour Regulations

17. Use of the harbour is governed by the Port of Cork Byelaws and you are referred to the following relevant documents:
18. Guidance notes for Leisure Craft
19. Port of Cork Byelaws 2016
20. All boats shall not impede Commercial Vessels navigating within the defined navigation channel.
21. All boats shall keep at least 150 metres away from the Refinery Jetty or Vessels moored alongside.
22. If found to have been in breach of item 20 and or 21 above, a boat may be disqualified from the race or league or event in which they are competing in or at the time of the incident.
23. Protests for infringement of 20 and or 21 above can be initiated by any club member who is witness to the infringement or by the Race Committee, if informed of an infringement by the Port authorities. Note the protest time limit will not apply to infringements of 19 and 20 above.

Time Limits

24. All non-coastal races have a time limit of 2.5 hours.
25. Boats failing to finish within 45 minutes after the first boat in non-coastal races sails the course and finishes will be scored Did Not Finish without a hearing.

Marks/Courses

26. Courses may be either:
27. Round the Cans
28. Coastal
29. Laid Windward / Leeward
30. Laid Triangle
31. Other Course types deemed appropriate by the Race Committee
32. Courses for each fleet shall be displayed on the CV Blackboard and on the VHF channel 71.
33. For 'laid' courses, marks will be black, orange or yellow inflatable buoys.
34. At the discretion of the Race Officer (RO), Round the Cans courses may be selected from the current Royal Cork YC Course Card.
35. For Round the Cans and Coastal courses, the marks used may be a combination of navigation marks, Port of Cork laid race marks, RCYC racing marks and inflatable buoys.

36. Port of Cork Laid Race Marks are yellow permanently laid and may be in these approximate locations.

Harp Mark	51° 47' .20 N	008° 14' .28 W
Ringabella Mark	51° 46' .39 N	008° 17' .78 W
Dosco (Corkbeg)	51° 49' .25 N	008 ° 15' .83 W

Starting/Finishing

37. Races will be started by using RRS 26 with the warning signal made 5 minutes before the starting signal.
38. Boats whose warning signal has not been made shall keep clear of the starting area during the starting sequence for other races.
39. The order of starts will be at the RO's discretion and may be announced on the VHF channel 71.
40. If a race is to be shortened at the start/finish line, the signal shall be the display of Flag "F" with repetitive sound signals at a mark on the course. Having rounded that mark, boats shall proceed directly to the finishing line and finish by crossing the line from the direction of the last mark. This is in addition to procedures in RRS 32.2
41. The first warning signal is scheduled for 1055hrs each day. On the last day of the series no warning signal will be made after 1530hrs.
42. A number of Start/ Finish lines may be used. These include:
43. Grassy Walk Line. The line is formed by Orange Pole in front of the hut at the Grassy Walk (on Camden shore). The ODM is Buoy C1 (Cage) Green. The finish line will be between the rear-most pole and the ODM or between the CV and the ODM.
44. Committee Vessel (CV). The Start and Finish line will be formed between a Red and White staff on the CV and an Inflatable Buoy or Navigation Buoy as indicated by the CV.

Protests and Requests for Redress

45. In addition to RRS 60.2, persons intending to protest shall inform the RO immediately upon finishing or retiring of their intention to protest.
46. Hearing requests shall be submitted online at <https://www.racingrulesofsailing.org/schedules/14594/event>.
47. For each class, the protest time limit is 90 minutes after the last boat in that class has finished the last race of the day.
48. Notices of protests by the Race Committee or Protest Committee will be posted to inform boats under rule 61.1(b).

Arbitration

49. RRS Appendix T (Arbitration) will apply.

Scoring

50. The scoring system used shall be the Low Point System of RRS Appendix A, except that where 4 or more races are completed 1 discard will apply and if 8 or more races are completed 2 discards will apply. .

Safety Regulations

51. A boat that retires from a race shall notify the RO as soon as possible.
52. All competitors must wear life jackets if the CV/PRO/RO displays Code Flag "Y"

Equipment and Measurement Checks

53. A boat or equipment may be inspected at any time for compliance with the class rules and sailing instructions.
54. Boat identification numbers (issued and recorded by Irish Sailing) shall be displayed on the Mainsail, Spinnaker, Gennakers, Code Zero or similar sails as prescribed by the IRC and RRS.
55. No boat shall race with its anchor protruding forward of the bow
56. For boats competing in Non-Spinnaker classes:
57. Only one mainsail and one headsail shall be set at any one time.
58. A headsail may be poled out only by means of a whisker pole or spinnaker pole, with the pole set to windward.
59. The use of boat hooks, booms, oars or any other similar apparatus to pole out, extend or otherwise hold out a headsail is prohibited.
60. The use of a whisker pole or spinnaker pole shall comply with RRS 55.2 and 55.3

Radio Communications

61. Except in an emergency, a boat shall neither make radio transmissions while racing nor receive radio communications not available to all competing boats. This restriction also applies to mobile telephones.
62. Courses may be announced on VHF channel 71 prior to starting sequence of that class.

Prizes

63. Daily prize giving will take place as soon as possible after sailing and expected to be no later than 18.00 hrs in the RCYC Club house. Prizes will be awarded at the discretion of the Race Committee.
64. Overall prizes will be awarded to 1st, 2nd and 3rd place in each Class in IRC and ECHO for Spinnaker and Non-Spinnaker divisions.
65. The final prizegiving shall take place after racing on the last day of the league.

Disclaimer of Liability

66. Competitors participate in the league entirely at their own risk. See RRS Rule 4, Decision to Race. The organizing authority will not accept any liability for material damage or personal injury or death sustained in conjunction with or prior to, during, or after the event.

Insurance

67. It is the duty of each boat owner to have their boat adequately insured against any risk, including civil responsibility to third parties and to ensure that such insurance remains valid for the entirety of the events sailed in.

WhatsApp Group

68. Please join the 2026 RCYC Autumn League group here:
<https://chat.whatsapp.com/FgrUO4M4yzK3Kwg9Zk5rFR>
69. Failure to post information on WhatsApp will not be grounds for a request for redress. WhatsApp is supplementary to the Official Notice Board arrangements stated in the Sailing Instructions.